PassFrame
TUITION

The Ant and the Butterfly

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction (Fable)

Extract — read it carefully before answering

One golden summer, a butterfly called Iris spent her days drifting from flower to flower, admiring her own reflection in the dewdrops. Below her, an ant named Moss worked without rest, carrying crumbs and seeds back to her nest beneath the old oak tree.

'Why do you work so hard?' Iris laughed, fluttering past. 'The sun is shining and summer will last forever!'

'Summer never lasts forever,' replied Moss, trudging onward with a seed twice her size balanced on her back. But Iris only laughed harder and flew off towards the meadow.

Weeks passed. The golden days grew shorter, and one morning a bitter wind swept through the meadow, scattering leaves like confetti. Iris's wings, so beautiful in summer, were useless against the cold, and she shivered beneath a drooping leaf, hungry and alone.

It was Moss who found her there. Without a word, the little ant brought her a crumb of bread and a seed from her own winter store.

'I thought you said summer would last forever,' said Moss gently. Iris lowered her eyes. 'I was wrong. Thank you for your kindness.' From that day on, whenever Iris saw an ant at work, she remembered the winter the ants had saved her life.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. Where did Moss the ant live?

2. What season does the fable begin in?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you Moss carried something heavier than herself.

4. Underline 2 words or phrases that show Iris was vain or proud.

5. What does “drifting” suggest about the way Iris moved between flowers?

6. Put these events in order: a bitter wind sweeps through the meadow / Moss brings Iris food / Iris laughs at Moss / Iris shivers under a leaf.

7. Why might the author have chosen the names “Moss” for the ant and “Iris” for the butterfly?

8. What changed about Iris's wings once winter came?

9. What does Moss's gift tell you about her character?

10. Find and copy a word that means the opposite of “generous”.

11. Why do you think Moss “said nothing” at first when she found Iris?

12. Write a new, one-sentence moral for this fable in your own words.